

OPEN HOUSE

a short film

Blue Sheep Films

working draft v1.1

INT. LUXURY DETACHED HOME - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Sunday light through very clean glass. Staged furniture that no one has ever sat on, arranged around a fireplace that has never known fire.

SAM (26) stands in the middle of it in his socks – shoes at the door, house rules – holding a glossy feature sheet like a program at a play.

He's dressed one notch up from his life. Collar. Decent jacket. The costume works.

He touches the mantel. Stands at the window. Checks a sightline from the couch to the kitchen the way an owner would, the way a man confirming a decision would.

A young couple drifts by arguing in whispers about closing costs. Sam nods at them like a neighbour.

MAIN TITLE: OPEN HOUSE

INT. LUXURY DETACHED HOME - PRIMARY BEDROOM - DAY

Sam in the doorway of a bedroom bigger than his entire apartment. Bed like a continent. His-and-hers closets.

He stands there a long moment. Not coveting. Something quieter than coveting.

Trying it on.

At the window: a backyard, a maple, a fence in good repair.

DARA (O.S.)

The yard gets full sun till four.

DARA (40s), realtor. Blazer, lanyard, flats that have done forty open houses. She's watching him from the hall with an expression he can't file.

SAM

It's a great yard.

DARA

It is. You have kids?

SAM

(half a beat)

Not yet.

DARA

Dog?

SAM
Eventually. Something dumb and
big.

DARA
They're the best kind.

She looks at him one second longer than comfortable. Then her phone goes and she's gone, and Sam breathes out and puts the feature sheet in his jacket with the others.

There are others.

INT. SAM'S BASEMENT APARTMENT - NIGHT

The whole apartment in one shot, because the whole apartment fits in one shot. A window at ankle height with a view of a driveway. A good little desk anyway. A bed, made properly.

Sam, home from work in a grocery store polo, unpins his name tag.

On the wall above the desk: feature sheets. A dozen of them, neat as diplomas. Four-bed on Rosemount. Loft on Argyle. The one with the maple.

He adds today's to the grid, squares the corners.

It is either the saddest wall in the city or a vision board. The film declines to vote yet.

INT. MODERN TOWNHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY (NEXT SUNDAY)

Different house. Same socks. Sam runs a hand along a waterfall counter, opens a drawer — soft-close, obviously — and lets it glide shut.

DARA (O.S.)
You again.

He goes still, caught mid-drawer.

Dara, arms crossed in the kitchen doorway. Different lanyard. Same eyes.

DARA (CONT'D)
Rosemount two weeks ago. Argyle
last week. You wore the same
jacket.

SAM
It's a good jacket.

DARA

Mm.

(stepping in)

Here's the thing. I ran you through my head. You're not casing places – you don't look at locks, you look at light. You're not a rival agent, they never take their shoes off. And you're not a buyer, because buyers criticize. Nothing's ever wrong with the house for you.

(beat)

So?

Sam sets the feature sheet down. The truth costs him.

SAM

I like seeing how it would go.
The – life. If I had it. You walk in, and for twenty minutes it's yours. The yard's yours. The dumb big dog is yours. Nobody checks.

(beat)

I stock shelves and I live in a basement and Sundays I – visit.

(beat)

You can kick me out. It's probably a rule.

Dara looks at him for a long moment. A decision happens behind her eyes.

DARA

You're doing it wrong.

SAM

I'm – what?

DARA

(walking past him)

You're browsing. Amateurs browse. Come here. You see this wall? Comes down. That's a load of nothing, that wall, and then your kitchen sees the garden. You cook?

SAM

(catching up)

I – yeah. Badly, but a lot.

DARA

Then you'd fix that. Herb boxes,
there, south light. And that
corner —

(pointing through)

— that's where the desk goes.
Morning sun, no glare. That's
where you'd write the thing
you're not telling anyone you
write.

Sam stares at her.

SAM
How did you—

DARA
Everybody's writing something.
Sit-down people write. You're a
sit-down person.

And just like that it's not trespassing anymore. It's a showing.

INT. / EXT. VARIOUS OPEN HOUSES - DAYS - SERIES

Sundays, stitched together:

- A century home. Dara raps a doorframe: "Original. They don't make trees like this anymore." Sam, deadpan: "I'd keep it." "Big of you."

- A condo with a lake view. They stand at the glass in silence. Dara: "No." Sam: "No." They leave without finishing the tour.

- A bungalow. Dara watches Sam linger in the small second bedroom. Says nothing. Writes nothing. Notices everything.

- Coffee in a staged kitchen from a thermos she brings, poured into two cups from her bag – she has done this before, for herself, alone. He clocks it. Files it.

- Sam saying "good bones" like he's earned it. Dara: "Don't say good bones." "You say it!" "I have a licence."

INT. STAGED CONDO - KITCHEN - DAY

Wine-coloured dusk light. Open house over – Dara flips the sign, kicks her flats off, and sits on the counter of a kitchen she's selling. Sam leans on the island, at ease in these rooms now, native.

SAM
Can I ask the thing I'm not
supposed to ask?

DARA
Two-forty condo fees and yes the
roof is done.

SAM
Where do you live?

Silence. Dara swirls her thermos cup.

DARA
Apartment on Dupont. Rented.
Eleven years.

SAM
You sell houses.

DARA
I sell houses. Forty a year. And
then I drive home to my rental –
with my commission cheque, which
is real money right up until you
see what these things cost.
(beat, the confession
under the shop talk)
You want to know why I didn't
kick you out? First week I had my
licence, I stood in a bedroom
like the Rosemount one and I
picked which side of the bed was
mine.
(beat)
Eleven years. I live in all of
them, kid. One hour at a time.

The staging lights hum. Two impostors in a display kitchen,
and the display kitchen never suspects a thing.

SAM
Which side?

DARA
Window side. Obviously.

SAM
Obviously.

INT. STAGED CONDO - ENTRY - DUSK

Leaving. Shoes back on, the small ritual of returning to
their real sizes. At the door Dara stops him.

DARA
Here. Before I talk myself out of
being unprofessional.

From her folder: a single printed listing. No gloss. No
staging photos. A third-floor walk-up apartment, dim photos,
brave wide-angle lens doing what it can.

SAM
(reading)
This is a rental.

DARA
Six-forty a month more than a
basement. Which is doable on
shelf-stocker money if the
shelf-stocker stops thinking
basement is what he's worth.
(tapping the photo)
Third floor. South light, real
light, all afternoon. Radiator
heat, which is ugly and works.
And that corner there –

She looks at him. Delivers the listing patter dead level,
eyes on his, every word load-bearing:

DARA (CONT'D)
– takes a desk.

Beat.

SAM
It's not the maple. It's not the
yard.

DARA
No. It's the first one.
(beat)
Everybody starts with a first
one, Sam. You're not visiting
your life. You're early for it.
There's a difference.

Sam looks at the ugly little listing like it's a feature
sheet. Folds it with the same care. Inside pocket. The one
close to the chest.

INT. THIRD-FLOOR WALK-UP - DAY

Empty apartment. Scuffed floors. Radiators like sleeping
dogs under the windows. South light absolutely everywhere,
uninvited, all over everything.

Sam stands in the middle of it in his socks. Old habit.

The LANDLORD (60s) waits in the doorway with a clipboard.

LANDLORD

It's not much, I know—

SAM

The wall stays. The light does
the work. Desk goes there —
(the corner, no
hesitation)
— morning sun, no glare.

The landlord looks at the corner. Looks at Sam.

LANDLORD

You've done this before.

SAM

(taking the pen)
Once or twice.

He signs against the wall, standing up, the way you sign
when there's no furniture yet because the furniture is
still coming.

INT. THIRD-FLOOR WALK-UP - DAY - LATER

The door props open with a paint can. Sam carries in the
good little desk — no couch yet, no bed frame visible, the
desk first, priorities of a sit-down person.

He sets it in the corner. Squares it. Sits.

South light, real light, all over him. No glare.

On the wall above the desk, he pins one single sheet: the
listing, ugly photos and all. First one in a new grid.

Room for more.

CUT TO BLACK.

THE END